

Episode 14: GW Memorial... Japanese Anime Protagonists Speaking Foreign Languages

Golden Week (GW) - how did everyone spend it?

In the end, I spent half my GW working. Well, this is fine too (bitter laugh). The only place I went out was the National Art Centre in Nogizaka. I went to see the "Monet Exhibition," but faced with the massive crowds and long lines at the ticket booth, I gave up on the "Monet Exhibition" 6 seconds after arrival. I just got swept along by the human wave and drifted through the equally crowded Tokyo Midtown.

Maybe because of that fatigue (← wrong), I completely mixed up the day of the week and totally missed yesterday's update deadline! (cries) So sorry (sweat).

Well then.

I think many people spent GW overseas, but did any of you watch anime during your travels? Japanese-made anime, specifically.

I once watched extensively from early morning in Rome, Italy. That day happened to be Saturday, and early morning seemed to be that kind of time slot. The works shown that day were *Future Boy Conan*, *Haikara-san ga Touru* (はいからさんが通る), *Lupin III*, and *Maison Ikkoku*. There were also 2-3 other older Japanese robot shows and classics on different channels, but I've forgotten the titles.

Japanese anime characters speaking Italian from a cheap Rome hotel TV! Somehow strange (laughs). Still, with *Lupin* and *Conan*, there was no sense of incongruity. Especially *Lupin* almost seemed to fit. *Conan* was around Episode 3, I think? By this point, I had most of the dialogue memorised, so it was probably being converted in my brain naturally.

But *Haikara-san ga Touru* and *Maison Ikkoku*... Content-wise, they're universal topics in a sense, so if Italians watched properly they'd naturally empathise, but the *Maison Ikkoku* episode that day had the Tohoku (?) Shinkansen stopped due to an accident or something, and the Ikkoku-kan residents started having a drinking party on the station platform... something like that (probably). **Ichinose-san with a sake bottle arguing with station staff in Italian...** hmm, surreal (laughs).

Though Italy is also a major railway country, and above all a cheerful country, so maybe such situations really exist there (bitter laugh).

Not anime, but I also watched old Japanese movies on TV. None other than "**Matango**." In Florence on Sunday at 10 AM! (laughs) I was just stunned. They were speaking proper Italian. Why "**Matango**" at such a time on Sunday? Too mysterious - my head was spinning (bitter laugh).

Not just Italy - in Switzerland, Germany, Greece, and Southeast Asian countries, I've repeatedly encountered Japanese anime being broadcast during travels. Japanese anime protagonists speaking each country's language. Unfortunately, I never got to watch works I was involved in, but it's purely happy that anime from our country, anime we know well, is being watched by so many people and children in various countries.

Oh yes, about 10 years ago now, when I first went to New York. I spent all night in the hotel watching cable TV anime channels. Japanese-made anime there were just scattered here and there. Most were American-made anime. However, one show surprised and made me very happy.

That work was *Muppet Babies*. One of the "collaborative works" once produced at Toei Doga. And amazingly, the episode airing on TV was one I had done colour direction for!

Man, I was moved! I never expected to reunite here! I was so happy I watched intently (laughs).

Something I was somewhat involved in remains like this, properly broadcasts somewhere in the world, and various people watch it. It's really happy. That's why I can't quit this job (laughs).

(07.05.09)